

Open Space Technology

What this tool produces · *Rapidly formed working groups, immediate action plans, and a highly motivated network of volunteers ready to tackle self-identified priorities.*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Social / User

Regulation

Preparing the workshop · *Open Space Technology*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Why this tool matters

Trusting the community entirely by surrendering control of the agenda; proving that when you give people empty space and real responsibility, they organically build their own governance.

Evidence we produce

Rapidly formed working groups, immediate action plans, and a highly motivated network of volunteers ready to tackle self-identified priorities.

Duration & Material

Duration · 1 to 2 days of self-organized workshops

Material · Large open room, blank agenda wall, flipcharts, markers, post-its

Reference case

In a coastal town facing rising flood risks, the local council utilized Open Space Technology. Within 30 minutes, the blank agenda wall was filled with citizen-led topics like "Redesigning our drainage system" and "Volunteer emergency networks." By the closing circle, working groups had set future meeting dates, and one team had already drafted a concrete grant application for flood defenses.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Marketplace · self-organized sessions

Duration
1 to 2 days of self-organized workshops

Marketplace board · propose, gather, run

Room	09:00-10:30	11:00-12:30	14:00-15:30
R1	topic ____ host ____	topic ____ host ____	topic ____ host ____
R2	topic ____ host ____	topic ____ host ____	topic ____ host ____
R3	topic ____ host ____	topic ____ host ____	topic ____ host ____
R4	topic ____ host ____	topic ____ host ____	topic ____ host ____

Open Space rules

Whoever comes are the rig...

Whoever comes are the right people

Whatever happens is the o...

*Whatever happens is the only thing that
could*

When it starts is the rig...

When it starts is the right time

When it is over, it is ov...

When it is over, it is over

The Law of Two Feet · mov...

The Law of Two Feet · move at any time

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.